

Customer Behavior Story: Agricultural Compliance & Record-Keeping Platform

Customer Profile

Primary Personas: Licensed pesticide applicators and farm operators in SE Missouri and 10-state region who apply EPA-regulated products.

Demographics: - Licensed applicators managing commercial spray operations - Farm operators conducting their own pesticide/herbicide applications - Agricultural consultants advising on compliance

Psychographics: - Values: Autonomy, efficiency, protecting their operation's reputation - Frustrations: Regulatory complexity, time spent on paperwork, fear of government oversight - Aspirations: Run operations confidently without compliance anxiety; scale without risk

Jobs to Be Done

Functional Job: Capture and organize EPA-regulated application records (regulations, product labels, GPS location, weather data, timing) into audit-ready compliance reports.

Emotional Job: Eliminate dread of government oversight and regulatory uncertainty; feel in control and confident during inspections.

Social Job: Maintain credibility with regulators, lenders, and peers; avoid embarrassment or loss of trust from non-compliance.

Trigger Event: Awareness that compliance rules are complex and knowable; peer gets fined; upcoming audit or inspection; desire to scale operation safely

Push Forces (Current Situation Pain)

Primary Pain Points: - Manual record-keeping: Hours spent gathering scattered data (weather apps, labels, notes) and reconstructing compliance evidence - Regulatory dread: Anxiety about government oversight while trying to make a living; fear of unknowingly breaking rules - Non-compliance risk: Potential \$10K+ fines; impact on business viability and growth - Knowledge gaps: Farmers doing their own applications don't understand all EPA RUP requirements

Frustration Threshold: Audit/inspection notice or peer's compliance fine triggers urgency

Hidden Costs: Time away from farming; hiring expensive consultants to manage liability; non-optimal decisions made to "feel safe"; delayed growth

Pull Forces (Solution Attraction)

Desired Outcomes: - Peace of mind: System automatically ensures compliance, eliminating second-guessing - Time savings: Log applications in minutes, not hours; generate reports instantly - Control & autonomy: Make decisions independently without hiring consultants or transferring liability - Confidence to grow: Scale operation safely knowing compliance is handled correctly - Proof when needed: Pull audit-ready records instantly during inspections

Magnetic Features: Offline-first (works in field with no signal); integrated EPA rules; automated compliance checking; GPS + weather capture

Success Vision: Run compliant operation on own terms; grow without regulatory fear; pass any inspection confidently

Anxiety Forces (Switching Concerns)

Top Concerns: - Software accuracy: Will app rules match actual EPA requirements? What if it misses something critical? - Company permanence: Will vendor survive long-term? (History of university solutions disappearing) - Learning curve: Too complex to use in field? Need training they don't have time for? - Data security: Concerns about cloud storage; where do records go; privacy of farm operation data? - Offline reliability: Will app sync correctly? What if connectivity fails during critical season?

Risk Perception: Switching to unproven software could create MORE compliance risk than status quo

Trust Barriers: Must know app is accurate, reliable, and company will persist

Anxiety Reducers: Proof of EPA accuracy; testimonials from trusted peers; free pilot with real applications; clear support/SLA

Habit Forces (Status Quo Comfort)

Current Behaviors: - Paper logs or spreadsheets: Understand them; know how to use; familiar workflow - Manual EPA lookups: Time-consuming but "normal"; doesn't feel broken if no recent fine - No formal system: "We've always done it this way" mentality; confidence from lack of consequences so far

Switching Costs: - Time: Learning new interface and workflows during busy application season - Money: Subscription cost feels like extra expense when current approach "works" - Social: Admitting

they've been doing it wrong; changing trusted processes

Inertia Factors: No recent regulatory trauma = low urgency; belief "it won't happen to me"; comfort with familiar methods

Decision Journey

Awareness: Triggered by peer getting fined, upcoming audit, consultant recommendation, or regulatory scare

Consideration: Research what compliance platforms exist; evaluate accuracy and reliability; assess time investment to learn

Decision: Will only commit if software proves it works, supports them, and company won't disappear. Free pilot during real application season removes risk.

Adoption: Needs training/support; must see immediate value in first uses; confidence that EPA rules are accurate

Loyalty: Retained by proven compliance accuracy, company stability, and integration into seasonal workflow

Key Influencers: Ag consultants, extension services, trusted peers who've used it, regulators they respect

Messaging Strategy

Core Message: Know you're compliant. No guessing. No fines. Just farming.

Push Messaging: "Stop the dread. Your peer just got fined. You could be next. One audit can change everything."

Pull Messaging: "Log applications offline. Know instantly you're compliant. Prove it in seconds. Scale confidently."

Anxiety Reduction: "Built with EPA requirements. Used by X applicators with zero compliance issues. Free pilot. We're here for 10 years."

Habit Breaking: "Takes 2 minutes per application. Works offline. No learning curve. Trusted by [peer names]."

Proof Points Needed: EPA accuracy verification; peer testimonials; case studies showing compliance success; company stability/funding; free trial with real applications